# Gaïa

## Production Bible

Gwenola Heck
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Liubov Popova
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Animated Short
3 Minutes
June 2024
Miniatures - Papercut - Puppeteering

# DIRECTOR'S NOTE

Since I was a child I perceived pregnancy as a pretty peculiar thing.

Coming at an age where many friends are getting pregnant
I increasingly get confronted with it.

Even if I have somewhat of an idea of whether I want this for myself
I am not sure to which degree this choice comes from myself
or from a reaction to the society I embody.

Exploring this society within the female body is an attempt
to grasp the power plays and influences that simmer within women.

# PRODUCER S NOTE

Gaia shows how hard it is to tell apart what we truly want from what others expect of us.

Having a child is a natural part of life, but it can also feel strange and almost unreal, like something from a science fiction story. The idea of a human growing inside another, changing the mother s body, is both amazing and tough.

This film uses powerful storytelling and stunning visuals to capture this duality, showing that these decisions are rarely made in isolation.

# TEAM

GWENOLA HECK

DIRECTOR

LIUBOV POPOVA

DIRECTOR

AMELIE KAHLO

ART DIRECTOR

FRANZISKA KABUTKE

CAMERAWOMAN

MANIK MOLLERS

SOUNDDESIGN

JAN WOLLENSCHLAGER

EDITOR

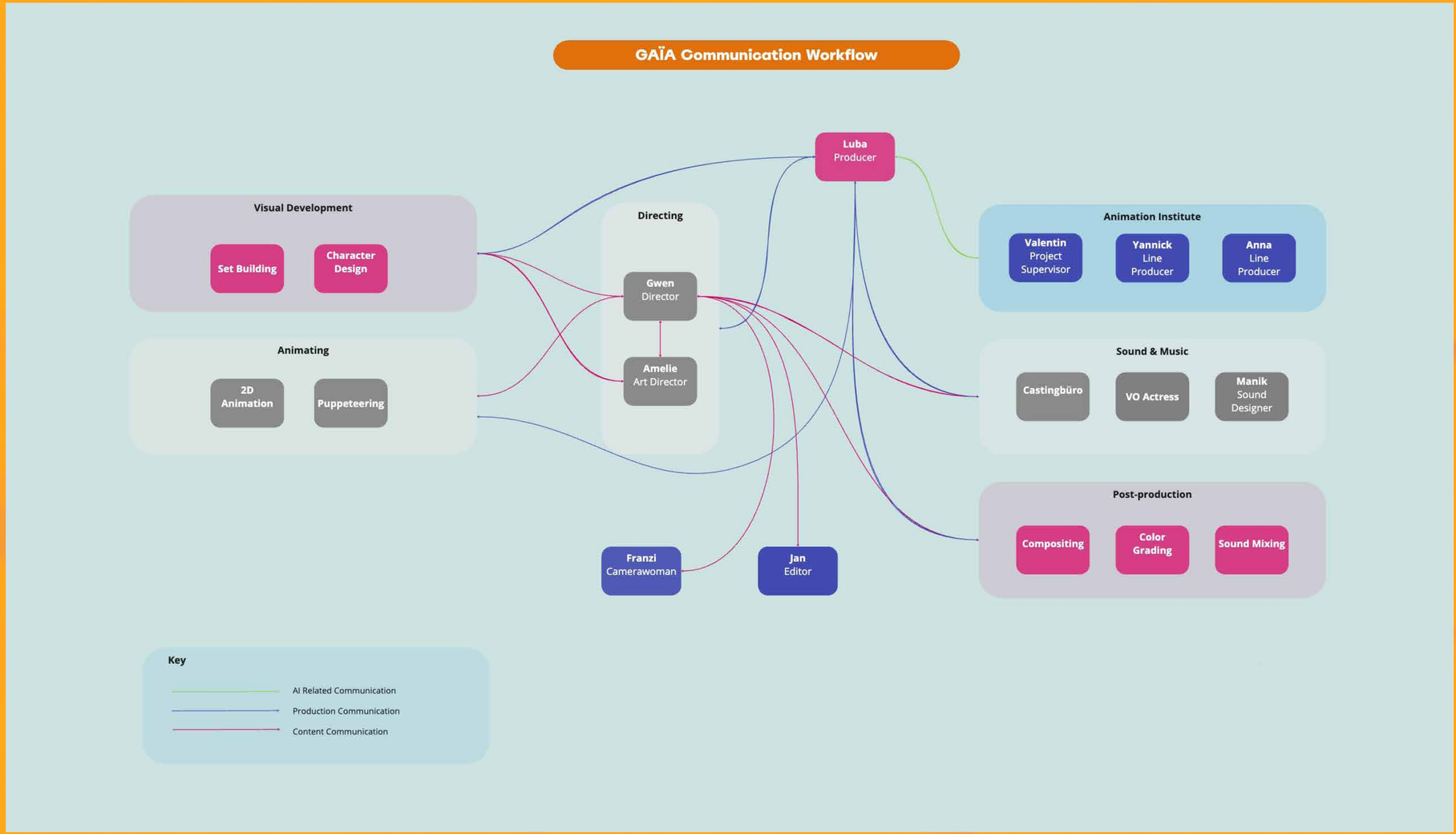
MALTE HARTLEB

TECHNICAL DIRECTOR

GINA STEPHAN

ANIMATOR

# TEAM COMMUNICATION WORKFLOW



# TEAM COMMUNICATION TOOLS

# RISK ANALYSIS

## GAÏA RISK ANALYSIS

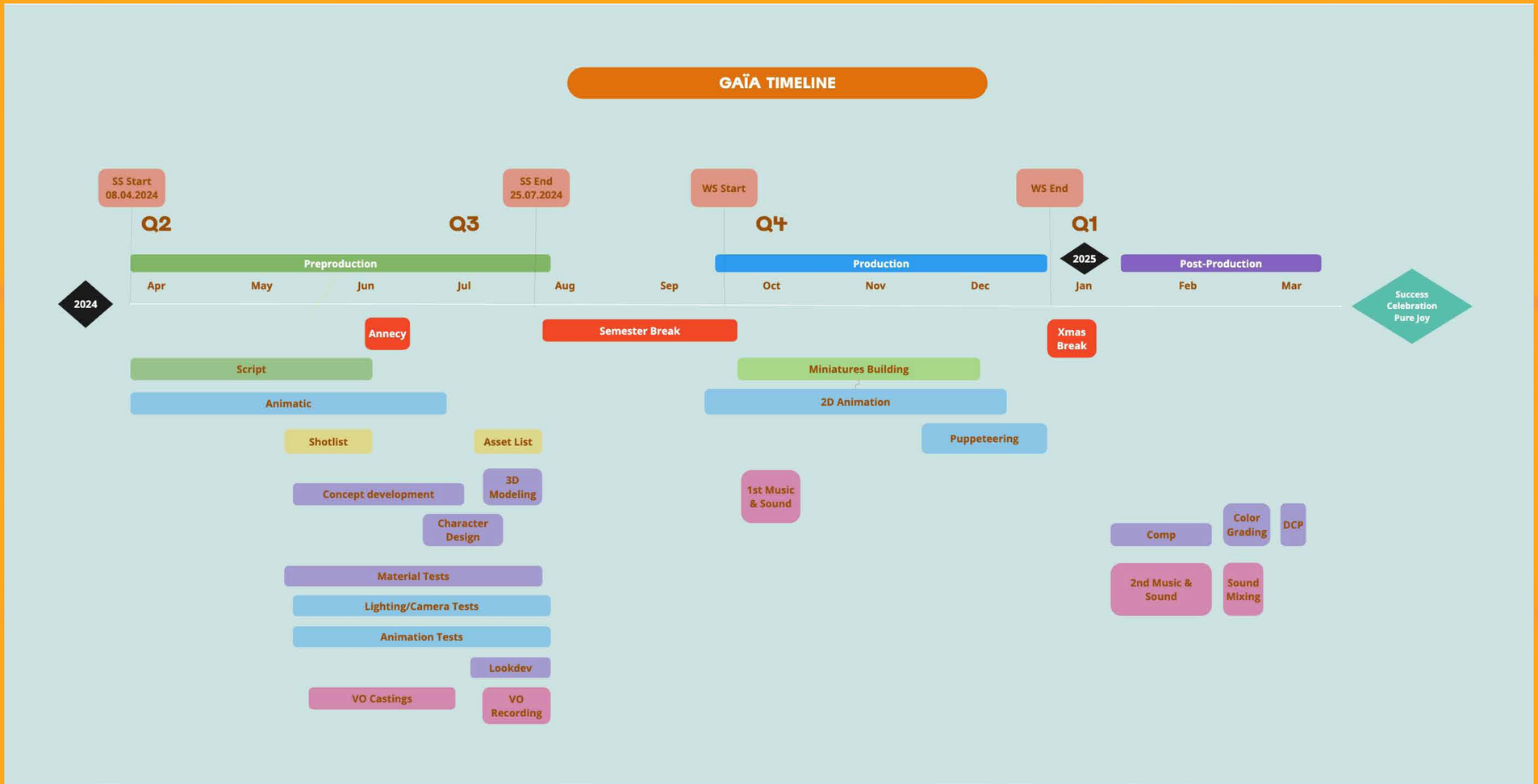
| Impact | Low | Possibly | Likely | Almost Guaranteed |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| High | Not enough time for animation | Too many set building needs // Damage or loss of equipment | Puppeteering becomes too challenging | Lasercutter out of order |
| Middle | Folder structure chaos | Lung issues because of the laser // Technical issues | Sickness | Not balancing all work loads // Laserfilter full, fusible out |
| Low | | Inner team conflicts // Not Communicating | Obtaining necessary equipment and materials takes too much time | Computer problems (not responding/ broken etc.) |

*Probability*

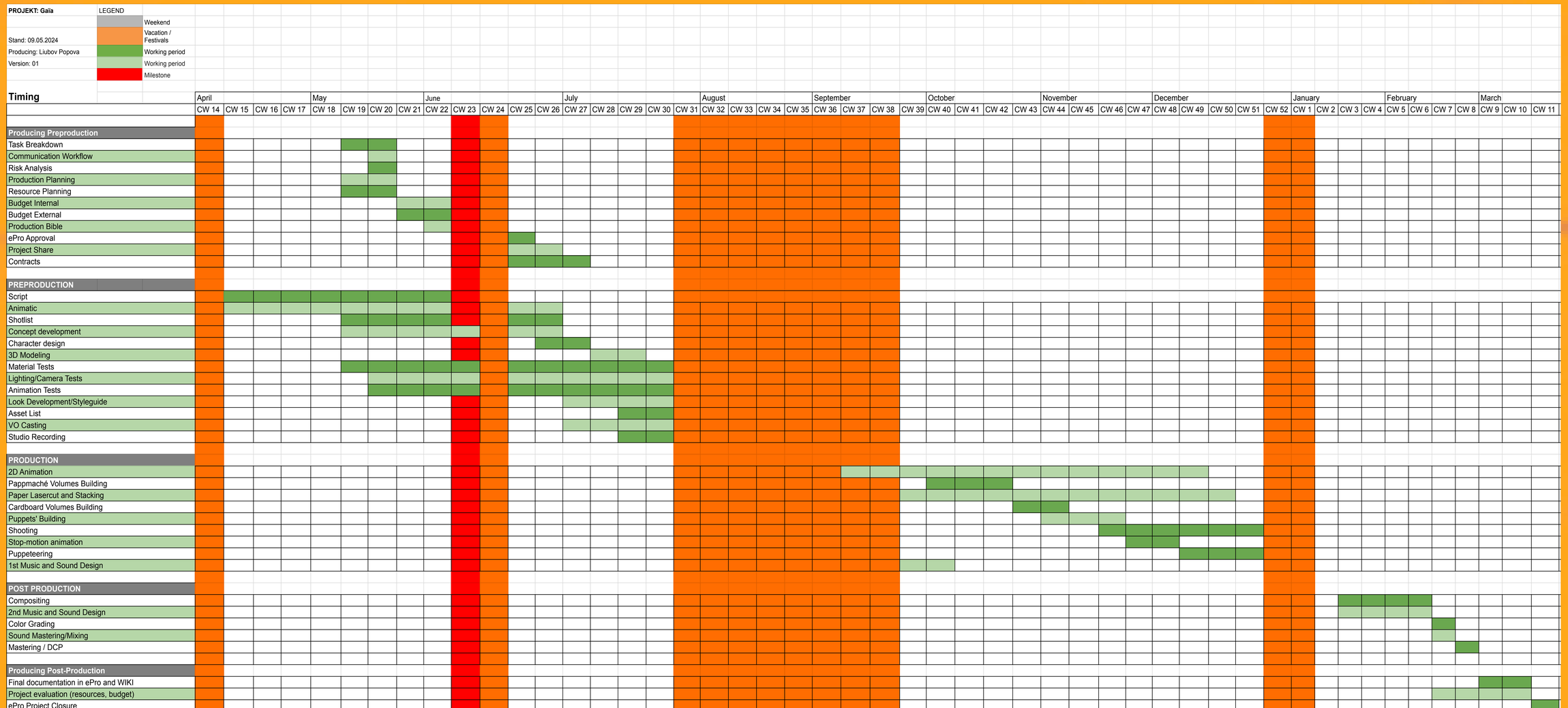
# RISK MANAGEMENT

| Issue | Solution |
|---|---|
| Folder structure chaos | Team briefing and pipeline overview, File Hand-over needs to be planned (File Type, Responsible Person, Responsible Review, Name Convention) |
| Not enough time for animation | Plan for loops, make test iterations for the money shots |
| Lung issues because of the laser | Always wear gas masks while working with laser. Repair the windows |
| Technical issues | Test new things as soon as possible |
| Inner team conflicts | Expectations and Roles Meeting + Team Events + regular feedback sessions |
| Not Communicating | Ensure everyone comes to meetings and shares there ideas and thoughts with each other |
| Obtaining necessary equipment and materials takes too much time | Be patient but remind about yourself regularly |
| Too many set building needs | Assess needs in advance. Form set building team reasonably |
| Damage or loss of equipment | Make additional protection for the equipment available. Instruct the team on proper handling of the equipment in advance |
| Puppeteering becomes too challenging | Test beforehand! Decide what would be simpler and achievable and go with that instead. |
| Sickness | Send people home early + make remote working a possibility. Other members should be prepared to take on more work. |
| Computer problems (not responding/ broken etc.) | Contact IT department of Animation Institute |
| Not balancing all work loads | Set certain times to work on other AKA modules and jobs outside of AKA |
| Laserfilter full, fusible out | Get introduction from Yannick on how to solve issues |
| Lasercutter out of order | Get direct contact to laser company in case of emergency |

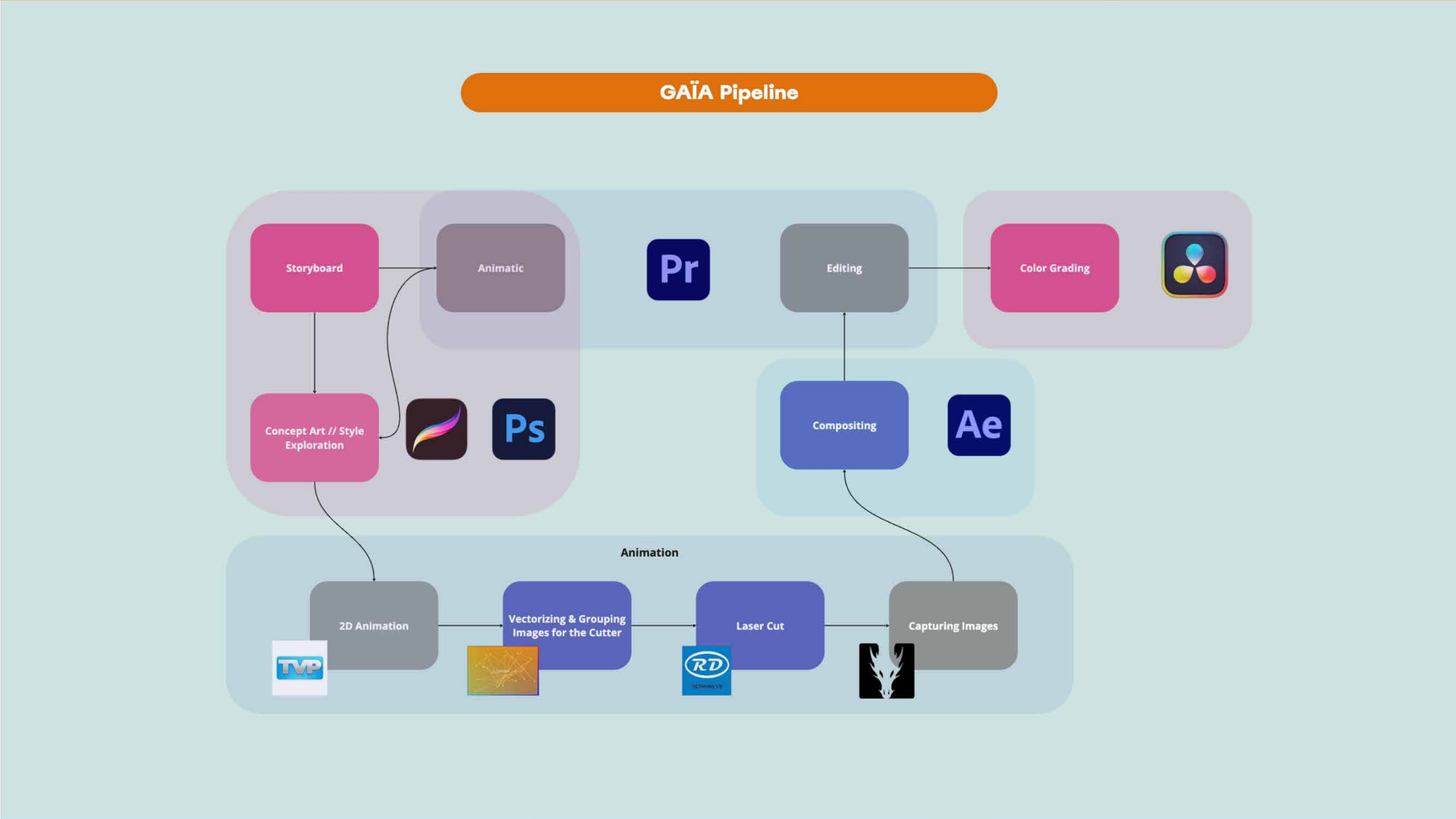
# TIMELINE


GAÏA TIMELINE
SS Start 08.04.2024
SS End 25.07.2024
WS Start
WS End
Q2
Q3
Q4
Q1
2024
2025
Preproduction
Production
Post-Production
Apr
May
Jun
Jul
Aug
Sep
Oct
Nov
Dec
Jan
Feb
Mar
Success Celebration Pure Joy
Annecy
Semester Break
Xmas Break
Script
Animatic
Shotlist
Asset List
Concept development
3D Modeling
Character Design
Material Tests
Lighting/Camera Tests
Animation Tests
Lookdev
VO Castings
VO Recording
Miniatures Building
2D Animation
Puppeteering
1st Music & Sound
Comp
Color Grading
DCP
2nd Music & Sound
Sound Mixing

# DETAILED SCHEDULE



# PIPELINE


GAÏA Pipeline
Storyboard
Animatic
Pr
Editing
Color Grading
Concept Art // Style Exploration
Ps
Compositing
Ae
Animation
2D Animation
Vectorizing & Grouping Images for the Cutter
Laser Cut
Capturing Images
TVP
RD

# INNOVATION

## TECHNICAL INNOVATION

- BUILT UP OWN TECHNIQUE BETWEEN REPLACEMENT ANIMATION AND PAPERCUT
- CREATED OWN PIPELINE TOOL TO GET EFFICIENTLY FROM DIGITAL 2D ANIMATION TO CUT OUT PAPER LAYERS

## TECHNIQUE INNOVATION

- UNCONVENTIONAL STYLE FOR HAPTIC PROJECT AS IT IS VERY GRAPHIC AND CLEAN UNLIKE CLASSIC STOP MOTION LOOKS
- USING LIGHT IN AN INDIRECT, TRANSLUCENT WAY UNLIKE THE CLASSIC WAY TO LIGHT PAPER SIMPLY FROM ABOVE
- TRIED OUT VARIOUS MATERIALS LIKE FABRIC, PAPPMACHE, CARDBOARD, PAPER, ROPE
- TRYING OUT UNCOMMON TECHNIQUE OF PUPPETERING FOR A CERTAIN SHOT

# INTERNAL BUDGET

**Gaïa**
calculation v01 / May 28th 2024

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Offline Schnitt** | | | **6 000,00 €** |
| Schnittraum Avid Media Composer (Animatic) | 500,00 € | 12 | 6 000,00 € |
| **Digitale Postproduktion** | | | **2 800,00 €** |
| Clipster (Mastering) | 1 000,00 € | 1 | 1 000,00 € |
| DavInci (Mastering) | 600,00 € | 3 | 1 800,00 € |
| **Ton-Postproduktion** | | | **4 800,03 €** |
| Ton-Filmmischung MUR 0.01 | 800,00 € | 2 | 1 600,00 € |
| Ton-Musikaufnahme MUR 0.13 | 0,01 € | 3 | 0,03 € |
| Ton-Musikaufnahme MUR 0.19 | 800,00 € | 4 | 3 200,00 € |
| **Filmmusic** | | | **1 800,00 €** |
| Midi Suite | 600,00 € | 3 | 1 800,00 € |
| **Animationsinstitut** | | | **131 970,00 €** |
| AI-DCC-Workstation | 65 700,00 € | 2 | 131 400,00 € |
| Posterdruck (maximal drei pro Projekt) | 20,00 € | 3 | 60,00 € |
| Project-Share Animationsinstiutut | 50,00 € | 10 | 500,00 € |
| Rendering Animationsinstitut | 10,00 € | 1 | 10,00 € |
| **HapticLAB** | | | **7 380,00 €** |
| 25 pcs Acrylic Brush Set | 9,00 € | 246 | 2 214,00 € |
| Hot air blower | 10,00 € | 246 | 2 460,00 € |
| Alu-Werkzeugkoffer | 1,00 € | 246 | 246,00 € |
| Manual pencil sharpener | 1,00 € | 246 | 246,00 € |
| Set of 4 tweezers | 5,00 € | 246 | 1 230,00 € |
| Spring clamp | 4,00 € | 246 | 984,00 € |
| **Mobile Technik** | | | **195 780,00 €** |
| Sony Alpha 7R II | 120,00 € | 106 | 12 720,00 € |
| Sony FX3 | 350,00 € | 106 | 37 100,00 € |
| Kamerastativ klein (75mm Kugelschale) | 30,00 € | 106 | 3 180,00 € |
| LAOWA 24mm/14 Makro/Probelens | 25,00 € | 106 | 2 650,00 € |
| Sony E 24-70mm f2.8 GM | 45,00 € | 106 | 4 770,00 € |
| Sony E 70-200mm f2.8 GM | 75,00 € | 106 | 7 950,00 € |
| Kamera-Magliner | 40,00 € | 106 | 4 240,00 € |
| Dedolight DLED4 Bi-Color Set | 110,00 € | 106 | 11 660,00 € |
| Dedolight Koffer | 50,00 € | 89 | 4 450,00 € |
| Dedolight Lightstream Set 25x25 | 165,00 € | 106 | 17 490,00 € |
| Aputure Amaran 60x | 65,00 € | 106 | 6 890,00 € |
| ARRI S60-C Skypanel | 240,00 € | 106 | 25 440,00 € |
| Carpetlight CL42 | 240,00 € | 106 | 25 440,00 € |
| Nanlite PavoTube II 6C RGB | 20,00 € | 106 | 2 120,00 € |
| Gripset | 150,00 € | 106 | 15 900,00 € |
| Alu-Stativ | 6,00 € | 106 | 636,00 € |
| Boom Arm - Junior | 12,00 € | 106 | 1 272,00 € |
| C-Stand | 15,00 € | 106 | 1 590,00 € |
| Heavyduty | 12,00 € | 106 | 1 272,00 € |
| PoleCat | 4,00 € | 106 | 424,00 € |
| Butterflyrahmen 6x6 ft. (klappbar) | 25,00 € | 106 | 2 650,00 € |
| Chimera Daylight M | 15,00 € | 106 | 1 590,00 € |
| Dimmer | 20,00 € | 106 | 2 120,00 € |
| Schuko 3fach-Verlängerung | 9,00 € | 106 | 954,00 € |
| Schuko Verlängerung 230V | 12,00 € | 106 | 1 272,00 € |
| | **TOTAL** | | **350 530,03 €** |

# EXTERNAL BUDGET

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Vorkosten** | | | **- €** |
| | | | - € |
| **Urheber- u. Leistungsschutzrechte** | | | **- €** |
| | | | - € |
| | | | - € |
| **Gagen** | | | **1 200,00 €** |
| actors allowance | 200,00 € | 1 | 200,00 € |
| sound design alumni | 500,00 € | 1 | 500,00 € |
| TD alumni | 500,00 € | 1 | 500,00 € |
| **Atelier** | | | **- €** |
| | | | - € |
| **Ausstattung** | | | **2 460,00 €** |
| general allowance | 200,00 € | 1 | 200,00 € |
| kleister | 5,00 € | 10 | 50,00 € |
| paper | 500,00 € | 1 | 500,00 € |
| cardboard | 30,00 € | 10 | 300,00 € |
| fabrics | 300,00 € | 1 | 300,00 € |
| foam boards | 30,00 € | 4 | 120,00 € |
| latex | 30,00 € | 9 | 270,00 € |
| gas mask | 50,00 € | 3 | 150,00 € |
| cleaning supplies | 50,00 € | 1 | 50,00 € |
| blenders (Zauberstab) | 100,00 € | 2 | 200,00 € |
| plaster bandages | 25,00 € | 8 | 200,00 € |
| puppeteering rigging | 12,00 € | 10 | 120,00 € |
| **Technik** | | | **- €** |
| | | | - € |
| **Reise- u. Transportkosten** | | | **626,00 €** |
| travel - voice recording GER (allowance for an actress) | 60,00 € | 2 | 120,00 € |
| accomodation GER | 120,00 € | 1 | 120,00 € |
| travel domestic - research trip | 26,00 € | 1 | 26,00 € |
| travel domestic - crew | 60,00 € | 6 | 360,00 € |
| | | | - € |
| **Filmmaterial** | | | **200,00 €** |
| SSD | 100,00 € | 2 | 200,00 € |
| **Postproduktion** | | | **- €** |
| | | | - € |
| **Allgemeine Kosten** | | | **150,00 €** |
| expendables | 150,00 € | 1 | 150,00 € |
| | | | - € |
| **Überschreitungsreserve** | | | **- €** |
| | | | - € |
| | **TOTAL** | | **4 636,00 €** |

# SUSTAINABLE PRODUCTION

To enhance the sustainability of Gaia production, we are going to implement the following practices throughout the production process:

1. Opt for paper products made from recycled and recyclable materials.
2. Recycle paper by ourselves. We are already using a lot of paper and cartoon from AKA trash bin for laser cutting and Pappmache.
3. Repurpose leftover materials from previous projects. Most of the animation tests by now were done with leftover paper from "It s Just a Whole" project.
4. Leverage virtual collaboration tools to reduce the need for in-person meetings and travel. Recording voiceover remotely will save time and resources while minimizing carbon emissions from transportation.
5. Record laser cutter power consumption with plug-in electricity usage monitor..

# DISTRIBUTION

## FESTIVAL SUBMISSIONS:

1. Tailor submissions to festivals like Annecy International Animated Film Festival, ITFS, Ottawa International Animation Festival, Animafest Zagreb, Anima Mundi, and KLIK Amsterdam Animation Festival, highlighting the film s experimental nature.
2. Consider applying to women-focused festivals such as the Athena Film Festival, Lady Filmmakers Festival, and Women in Film and Television International.
3. Emphasize the unique combination of animation techniques in promotional materials and submission packages.

## ONLINE PRESENCE AND PROMOTION:

1. Utilize Film Academy s social media platforms to tease the film and engage with the animation community.
2. Maintain a consistent promotional effort, updating followers about festival selections and awards.

# THANK YOU!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Producer

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## Gwenola Heck

Director

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